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Eric Wilkins, a resident of Chicago's Roseland neighborhood on the Far South Side, stands at 107th Street and Michigan Avenue. His federal lawsuit accuses Chicago police of conducting racially discriminatory traffic stops. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Political heat rises over police stops

Illinois lawmakers want to tighten an anti-quota law, but they face opposition from municipal officials

By Jeremy Gorner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SPRINGFIELD — Mayor Brandon Johnson's administration recently agreed to pay nearly \$1 million to settle a lawsuit brought by Chicago police Lt. Franklin Paz, who alleged he was dumped from a citywide unit after refusing to pressure subordinate officers to meet traffic stop and arrest quotas set by department higher-ups.

Eric Wilkins knows the other side of that equation. By the time Chicago was settling with Paz, Wilkins was two years into an

ongoing federal lawsuit accusing Chicago police of conducting racially discriminatory traffic stops primarily on Chicago's South and West sides, where most Black and Latino residents reside, compounding that harm by requiring officers to satisfy quotas. It's a process that he says people in the neighborhood call "fishing."

"It's like certain streets you know not to be on at certain times," said Wilkins, a Black resident of Chicago's Roseland neighborhood on the Far South Side. "In my earlier years, my dad always

taught me 'just say yes, Sir, no, Sir. Let them take care of their business so you can go about your business.'" Now, Illinois lawmakers are entering the fray over traffic stop and arrest quotas with legislation they say will address the root cause of the problem.

A bill that passed the House 107-0 on Wednesday would prohibit municipal police departments across the state from evaluating officers based on "any quantifiable contact" they have with individuals during their shifts, including traffic stops, arrests and written warnings. The legislation now heads to the Senate.

Current state law signed in 2014 by then-Gov. Pat Quinn bans police departments from assigning citation quotas or evaluating

officers by how many tickets they write. Chicago was exempt until 2019. But sponsors of the new bill say the existing law contains a significant loophole: It does nothing to prevent police supervisors from using broader "points of contact" — stops, arrests, warnings and similar interactions that stop short of citations — as performance metrics. Critics say the result is a de facto quota system operating under a different name.

"When officers are evaluated on how many contacts they generate, it introduces institutional pressure to create suspicion rather than to respond to it," the bill's main sponsor, Republican state Rep. Patrick Sheehan of Lockport, himself a Plainfield police officer, testified before the House Police and

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Trump seeks blockade of strait

After negotiations crumble, president targets Iran's hold

By Munir Ahmed,
Josh Boak, Sam Metz
and Samy Magdy
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ISLAMABAD — President Donald Trump on Sunday said the U.S. Navy would "immediately" begin a blockade of ships entering or leaving the Strait of Hormuz, after U.S.-Iran ceasefire talks in Pakistan ended without an agreement or next diplomatic steps in sight.

U.S. Central Command, which oversees military operation in the Mideast, on Sunday afternoon announced it will begin a blockade of Iranian ports on Monday at 10 a.m. Eastern, in the evening in Iran. It said the blockade would be "enforced impartially against vessels of all nations" entering or departing Iranian ports and coastal areas.

It said it would still allow ships traveling between non-Iranian ports to transit the strait. Traffic there has been limited even in the days since the ceasefire. Marine trackers say over 40 commercial ships have crossed since the start of the ceasefire.

In his first public comments after the 21-hour talks, Trump sought to eliminate Iran's key source of

See **IRAN** on Page A2



Vice President JD Vance, left, speaks with Pakistani military official Asim Munir, right, after attending talks on Iran in Islamabad, Pakistan, on Sunday. **JACQUELYN MARTIN/AP**

MORE COVERAGE: US-Iran talks in Pakistan end without agreement, **Nation & World, B1**



Former McDonald's executives Domineca Neal, left, and Vicki Guster-Hines, photographed on April 9, 2026. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

McDonald's suit will head to trial in changed times

Climate around diversity efforts has shifted since Black execs brought case

By Robert Channick
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

In January 2020, months before the death of George Floyd at the hands of Minneapolis police ignited a national movement toward corporate diversity and inclusion programs, two Black McDonald's executives filed a racial discrimination lawsuit against the fast-food giant.

This fall, after more than six years of navigating the federal judicial system, Vicki Guster-Hines and Domineca Neal will finally have their day in court.

"It's been grueling," said Guster-Hines, 64. "However, we finally got here, and so now it's our turn. Now

it's our time to tell our story, and we are ready to tell it."

In their lawsuit, Guster-Hines and Neal, longtime employees who last worked out of the company's Dallas office, cited a "hostile and abusive work environment" that included threats, derogatory racial comments and impediments to advancement for Black people within the corporate ranks at Chicago-based McDonald's.

Last month, a Chicago federal judge dismissed the race discrimination counts but ruled the case against McDonald's for an alleged hostile work environment, which the plaintiffs claim derailed their careers, can proceed to trial in September.

Both sides are claiming victory.

"This is a pretty big hurdle to get a hostile work environment claim like this against somebody like

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NATION & WORLD

'House-cleaning' in DC

Sexual assault and misconduct allegations against Rep. Eric Swalwell, D-Calif., have also supercharged a push in Congress to expel a group of lawmakers in both parties facing serious accusations of wrongdoing. **B1**

ARTS & LIVING

All that jazz dancing

Giordano Dance Chicago's latest program, performed over the weekend in Chicago, is a stellar example of a company that's continuing to push itself after more than six decades. **B5**

SPORTS

Schultz to make Sox debut

The White Sox made it official that pitching prospect Noah Schultz, who has excelled this season with Triple-A Charlotte, will start Tuesday's series opener against the Tampa Bay Rays at Rate Field. **C1**

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